TRT 03

Anastrozole

Non-steroidal aromatase inhibitor, a tablet that blocks the enzyme turning testosterone into estradiol



CLASS
Small molecule (aromatase inhibitor)

STUDIED FOR
Breast cancer; estrogen in men

HUMAN EVIDENCE
Large trials; FDA approved

US STATUS
FDA approved (Arimidex) · men off-label

STUDIED FOR

- **Breast cancer** — HUMAN
- **Testosterone in men** — HUMAN
- **Bone in older men** — HUMAN
- **Breast growth (boys)** — HUMAN

Use in men is off-label. Every approved use is in postmenopausal women. Trials in men measured hormones, bone and body composition.

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- ATAC: postmenopausal women, 10-year follow-up
- Men: RCTs of 26 to 88 men
- Male trials: no change in strength or symptoms

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term use in men
- Bone effects in men
- Dose for men

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Anastrozole ▶ Aromatase ▶ Less estradiol ▶ Testosterone, LH

- **Label:** selectively inhibits aromatase, which makes estrone and estradiol
- **Label:** no direct progestogenic, androgenic or estrogenic activity in animals
- **In men,** testosterone and LH rose and estradiol fell in small trials

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE
About 50 hours (label)

ROUTES STUDIED
By mouth (tablets)

PHARMACOKINETICS
Peak within 2 hours; liver metabolism about 85% (label)

SOLD AS
Prescription tablets (Arimidex); use in men off-label

MONITORED IN TRIALS
Bone density, cholesterol (label)

SPORT (WADA)
Prohibited, class S4

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved 1995 for breast cancer (women)
FDA	Use in men is off-label
WADA	Prohibited at all times (S4.1)

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Arimidex prescribing information, Mar 2026
2. J Clin Endocrinol Metab, anastrozole in older men (Burnett-Bowie et al.), Dec 2009
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

Adonis Men's Health · checked Nov 2026. Research and regulator records only. Not medical advice.

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